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*Courtesy Marge and Frank McQueary

PREFACE

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The modern revival of Clan MacQuarrie started about the middle of this century. Up until then there had been a number of family reunions and gatherings of that type. But, in 1960 a Gathering was held in Pulaski County, Kentucky, USA that tried to pull together MacQuarries not closely related to each other. (All MacQuarries came originally from the Isle of Ulva in Scotland and therefore if one is willing to go back say 8-10 generations, 200-250 years, we are probably all related.) The Kentucky Gathering drew many from the Central USA and had as its principal speaker, Heath MacQuarrie, a member of the Canadian Parliament. This group became a kernel for the renaissance of the Clan.

About 10 or 20 years earlier and independent of any clan group, a young Scotsman by the name of R. William Munro came across some material about the Clan, became intrigued by it and began to amass more information and publish articles about the Clan. All MacQuarries are indebted to "Billie" Munro for what he has done about helping us learn about ourselves.

During the 1970s several of us separately began to bestir ourselves to reach out beyond our immediate families. John R. MacQuarrie of Nova Scotia, Diana MacQuarrie of Pennsylvania and Greg McQueary of Illinois, deserve mention, but there were many others. Letters were written, newsletters sent out and we learned there were a lot of MacQuarries out there who were interested in their Clan heritage and roots; many more MacQuarries than we even thought existed. Formal branches of the Clan were established (Central USA, Northeast USA, Nova Scotia, Ontario and Scotland) and we learned later of small groups in California and Texas.

In the 1980s the Clan had 5 International Gatherings: 1983 in Arisaig, Nova Scotia; 1985 Isle of Mull, Scotland; 1986 Somerset, Kentucky; 1987 Truro, Nova Scotia and 1988 Sydney, Australia. In addition there was a large Gathering in Ontario (1983) and many regional meetings in California, Texas, Indiana, New Brunswick, Massachusetts, Connecticut, Prince Edward Island, etc.

While this was going on, many Clan members expressed the need for a Clan MacQuarrie History. Many larger clans had histories of varying length and quality. During the 1980s several attempts were made to have a history written, but none came to fruition.

About 2 years ago Frank & Marge McQueary told me of a manuscript written by Rev. Rodney McQuary and they asked if it might be used. Rodney's church (Malibu Community Presbyterian Church) as a token of its esteem, gave him a gift of a month-long trip to Scotland. In July 1962, Rodney spent 8 days on the Isle of Iona, a few more days on the Isle of Mull and the rest of the time in Edinburgh doing research in Librarys. As he says, "My purpose was not to seek out and write a history of the MacQuarrie Clan in detail, so much as to describe the environment of events, ideas and institutions in which they lived for so many centuries."

The result is a grand manuscript, of 120 typewritten pages, that delves into the religious and political history of Scotland while indicating how the MacQuarries fitted into it. I am amazed he was able to do so much in only 1 month. Including the overall picture of Scotland, I think, makes it a much better Clan History

than most others I have read. On the other hand, in my opinion, he has included much of personal interest to himself that may not be as appealing to a general MacQuarrie audience. He has 16 pages on staying at the Abbey on Iona with 3 pages telling of a particularly moving communion service he participated in. 10 more pages describe his tour around Mull which was largely by ship, involved only 1/2 day of land travel and did not include Ulva itself.

Rodney is now deceased, but I think I have indirect permission from his descendants to edit his material and include it in this book about MacQuarries; it is Part II. Rodney has quite flair for words and I have tried to retain this. At points where there has been condensation or editing that did not change Rodney's intent or meaning, there is no indication. However, where new material has been inserted it has been enclosed by brackets [].

Many people are not aware of and Rodney does not make clear that the "Scottish people" are not today and never were one homogeneous ethnic group. For centuries the dichotomy between the Highlanders and the Lowlanders has shaped Scottish society and history. The Highlands were basically of Celtic stock, more closely related to the Irish or Welsh than the Lowlanders. They had a completely different language, Gaelic, and culture. The Lowlanders were ethnically closer to the English and spoke a language that was at most a dialect or corruption of English. They were more sophisticated, educated and in their mind more civilized than the Highlander whom they considered uncouth, barbaric and little more than savages.

All the universities were and are in the Lowlands, as has been the government of Scotland for many centuries. Highlanders were considered at best, hill-billies, country bumpkins and someone to look down your nose at. On their part the Highlanders resented the political power of the Eastern establishment, and cherished there independent spirit and reputation as fierce fighters.

The MacQuarries were Highlanders and much of our history is made clearer by knowing that fact. This may explain our contrariness and why we are spread throughout the world.

In addition to Rodney's work, I've included from a variety of sources things that might be interesting to MacQuarries. I have consulted and asked for suggestions from a number of people both inside and out of the Clan: historians, journalists, writers, etc. All this advice was very valuable and I appreciate it. In the end though, I had to make decisions and at times did so in in unorthodox ways. (The MacQuarrie contrariness).

In order to save space and keep costs reasonable, I did such things as: put only 1 space after periods, use figures even at the begining of a sentence, sometimes use nonstandard spelling, etc. e.g. When the spell-check on my computer balked at the word "begining", I looked in the dictionary. It said: beginning, pronounced begining. So I thought, what the heck. I hope nobody finds this too distracting.

I have tried to credit material used from other sources, but the origin of some of Rodney's quotes is not clear. Also he used material from Munro without quotes, although he acknowledges the source. In editing, some has been altered, but a lot is still

very close to Munro's words. If he or anyone else is upset by a lack of attribution, I apologize, but didn't know what to do.

My hope is that this work will spur others into writing books about the various MacQuarrie branches; it would be nice to have books titled "The MacQuarries who settled in..." There are surely errors in this book and I hope people will find will find then and tell us. I look forward to the day when someone more qualified than Rodney or me will write a better MacQuarrie History. In the meantime we hope you enjoy this one.

One last comment about the use of the words Scots, Scottish and Scotch. Many of us were brought up to be proud of being "Scotch". It was a surprise when I told this to a native of Edinburgh and he replied with a snarl, "No, you're not or you wouldn't use that word." It seems that many people from Scotland resent the use of the word Scotch except for referring to that amber liquid that comes in a bottle.

I spent many years trying to find the reason for this. The 1st thing I noticed was that the people most offended were Lowlanders; the Highlanders just laughed and said it didn't matter. Later a man from Scotland who knows a lot about Scottish history said he felt the distinction began early in the 20th century and gave this explanation. Whiskey has been made in the Highlands of Scotland for centuries. In the 19th century it began to be exported around the world and became famous as "Scotch". Scotland has always been ambivalent about whiskey; many like their wee drop, but many are teetotal. By the end of the 19th century many Scots objected to using the same word for whiskey and people. Since this was after the great migrations many of Scotch descent would not be aware of the change of usage.

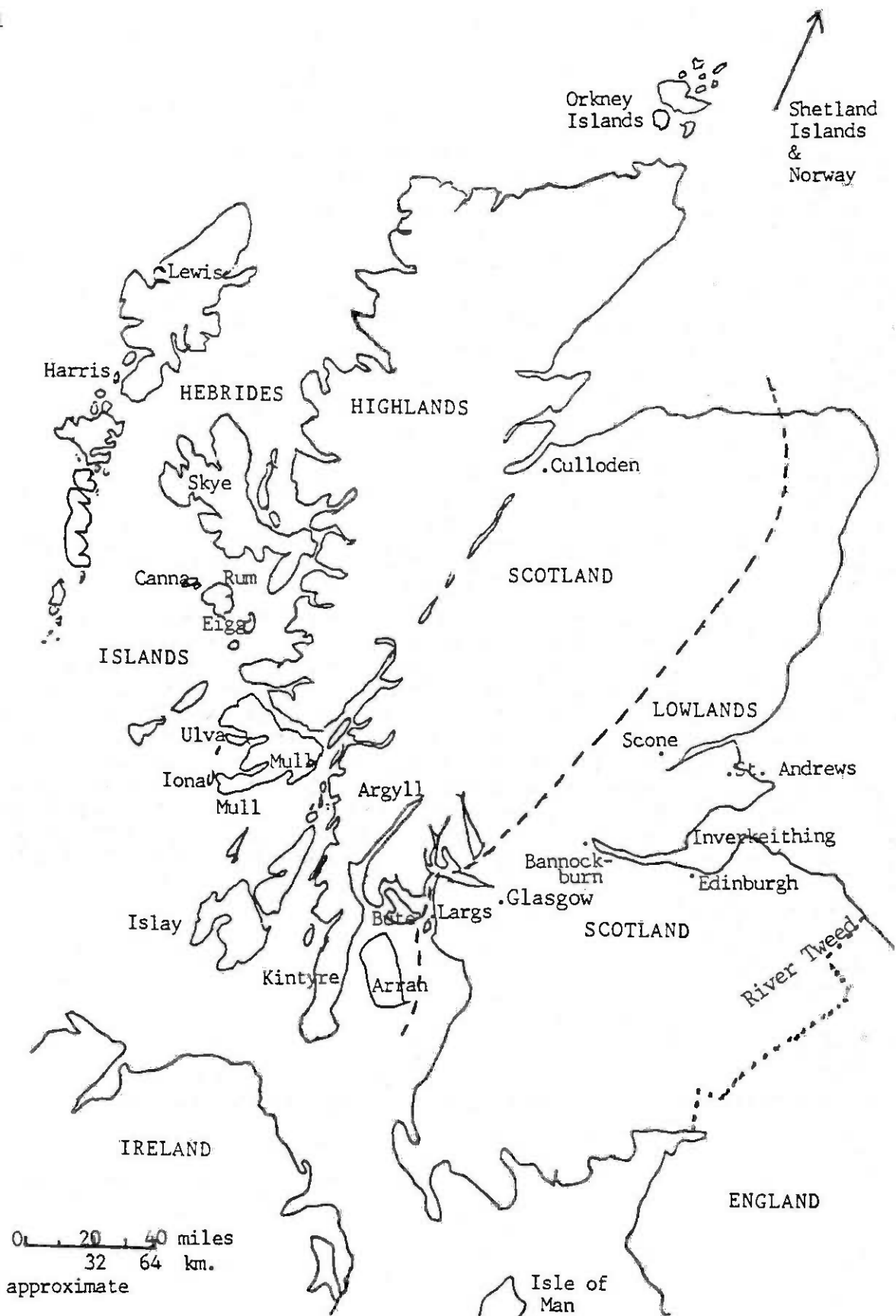
However, maybe the Lowlanders are just upset because all the good "Scotch" is made in the Highlands. Anyway, I have freely used the words Scot, Scots, Scotch and Scottish. My authority is John Galbraith[22] and his book about Canadians, "The Scotch".

Bruce McQuarrie
10 Eames Dr.
Auburn, Mass
U.S.A. 01501

May, 1989

"The error column view with pride,
At least is shows that you have tried."

Edgar Guest



A CHRONOLOGY OF MACQUARRIE HISTORY
 compiled by James MacQuarrie, Norwood, Mass. USA

MACQUARRIE HISTORY	YEAR	CONTEMPORARY HISTORY
GAELIC/ANGLICIZED UIDHIR/GUAIRE		
Guaire, a direct descendant of King Kenneth MacAlpin, Progenitor of Clan MacQuarrie. Brother of Finguine, Progenitor of Clan MacKinnon.	850 900	Kenneth MacAlpin, King of Scots and Picts. Norse occupation of the West of Scotland.
Clan attacked and dispersed by the Norse and their supporters for allying with King Alexander II, who died of fever during his campaign to drive the Norse from the Western Isles. Chief Cormac Mhor(MacQuarrie) killed in this battle; his sons Alan and Gregor flee to Ireland.	1222 1249	Alexander II, King of Scots conquers Argyll. Alexander II dies at Kerrera.
King Alexander III defeats the Norse at Largs and Claims the Western Isles for Scotland. Alan(MacQuarrie) returns from Ireland to become chief of the Clan. Gregor stays in Ireland.	1263	1st meeting of the Council of the Isles held on the Isle of Eigg. 14 chiefs make up the council. MacQuarrie is a member.
Chief Hector, Grandson of Alan joins Robert Bruce at Bannockburn in the victorious fight for Scottish independence. The Clan fights with distinction, but Chief Hector is killed.	1306 1314	Robert Bruce crowned King of Scotland John MacDonald of Islay assumes title of 'Lord of the Isles'. 1329 Death of Robert Bruce.
A MacDonald Seanachaidh(Bard) ranks the MacQuarrie Chief high in the Council of the Lord of the Isles because 'He has an ancient pedigree'.	1400 1406	Council of the Isles hold regular meetings at Eilean na Comhairle on the Isle of Islay. Scottish King James I captured by English.
The Battle Harlow is fought between the Regent Albany and the Lord of the Isles over the disputed Earldom of Ross. The MacQuarries support the Lord of the Isles in an indecisive fight. Heir to MacQuarrie Chiefship, name not recorded, is killed in battle.	1411 1412 1422	Donald 2nd Lord of the Isles educated at Oxford, claims Earldom of Ross. St. Andrews University founded. Alasdair, 3rd Lord of the Isles, maintains hereditary warfare against the Scottish crown.

Chief John is witness to charters granted by the Lord of the Isles in Tain and Dingwall.

Prior to his death, Chief John is recorded as corresponding secretly with Edward IV of England, likely connected with the Lord of the Isles alliance with the English King.

James IV of Scotland forfeits title of Lord of the Isles. MacDonald dominance fades in the West. MacQuarries ally with the Macleans.

Rebellion breaks out under Donald Dubh MacDonald in an effort to gain lost 'Lord of the Isles' title. Parliament calls on the Chiefs in the Isles, including MacQuarrie, to support royal forces. Chief Dunslaf (MacQuarrie), son of John, support Donald Dubh.

Chief Dunslaf and others are often summoned before Scottish Parliament to answer to treason. After some refusals, Dunslaf submits; his punishment is not recorded. Donald Dubh's insurrection is unsuccessful.

Dunslaf and other Clan Chiefs are ordered by crown to pay Duncan Stewart of Appin and his Clan for cattle and goods 'that they had taken'.

Island Clans rise unsuccessfully again under Donald MacDonald of Lochalsh. Dunslaf and Clan receive pardon from Regent Albany for treason.

MacQuarrie of Ulva and others often summoned before Parliament, but fail to appear.

1463 Orkney and Shetland Isles acquired from Norway by Scotland.

1473 John 4th and last Lord of Isles conspires with Edward IV to attack the lowlands.

James III, King of Scotland assassinated.

1492 Christopher Columbus discovers new world.

1493

1503

1504

1509

1513 King James IV of Scotland
1517 & most of Scottish nobles killed in battle against English at Flodden, greatest Scottish defeat in history.

1531 James V, king of Scotland, visits the Highlands.

John, natural son of Dunslaf, receives letters of legitimacy and confirmation as Chief from King James V.

1538 Death of James V. Mary, Queen of Scots, born.

Chief John with the council of Donald MacDonald of the Isles enters into a formal treaty with Henry VIII of England to attack the Scottish lowlands. Queen Mary gives Chief John a pardon for assisting English in burning the Isles of Bute and Arran and other crimes.

1545 English expedition to the Western Isles.

MacQuarrie lands granted to Maclean of Duart by the crown. Maclean conveys clan lands back to MacQuarrie. Mixup occurred when Maclean had MacQuarrie's charters renewed with his own.

1553

1561 Queen Mary returns to Scotland from France.

1575 Regent Moray, illegitimate son of James V murdered by Scottish nobles.

Alexander MacQuarrie recorded as student at St. Andrew's University.

1577

1587 Queen Elizabeth executes Queen Mary in England.

Chief Hector, John's son, following Maclean of Duart against MacDonalds & MacIans of Ardnamurchan, receives a pardon for devastating Isles of Rhum, Eigg & Canna.

1588

1588 A surviving ship from the Spanish Armada sunk at Tobermory, Isle of Mull.

Chief Hector supports Maclean of Duart in his infiltrations of Islay and Jura. The MacDonalds consider this a menace to the trade routes to Ireland and resist. Macleans achieve small compensation for their substantial losses, including their chief. A few MacQuarries remain in Islay and Kintyre.

1588

Highland landowners ordered to prove their right to possess titles.

Chief Hector receives a pardon for slaughters of MacDonalds in Kintyre and Islay.

1591

1603 Union of Scottish & English kingdoms. James VI, King of Scots becomes King James I of England

Chief Gillespie one of chiefs 1609
summoned to sign 'Statutes of
Iona', an attempt by Bishop to
pacify the Hebrides after cen-
tury of near anarchy caused by
power vacuum when MacDonalds
lost Lordship of the Isles and
their hold on island clans.

Islay granted to the
Campbells.

Murdoch MacQuarrie recorded as 1618
student at Glasgow University. 1621

Pilgrims land at
Plymouth, Mass., USA.

Cathal & Archibald MacQuarrie 1627
in France as bowmen under Mac-
lean of Duart. MacQuarries re-
puted excellent with long bow. 1625

Death of James VI & I.

Direct descendant of Gregor, 1627
2nd son of Cormac Mhor(1249),
and Chief of Irish McGuires,
is given title of Lord Ennis-
killed by King Charles I.

Donald XII of Ulva confirmed 1630
heir to his grandfather Hector
and marries Christina grand-
daughter of Maclean of Duart.
They have 4 sons, 2 daughters:
Alan(his successor), Hector,
Lachlan and John, founders of
Ormaig, Laggan & Ballighartan
branches. Unnah & Catherine
marry Macleans.

1633 King Charles I visits
Scotland.

1642 Civil war waged in England
& Scotland between
Royalists & Parliament-
arians.

Supporting the Stewart dynasty 1645
during civil war, MacQuarries
fight with Marquis of Mont-
rose at Battle of Kilsyth.
MacQuarries under Ewen Maclean
help carry the day with a
fierce charge.

Alan XIII of Ulva, son of Don- 1648
ald XII, authors a manuscript
clan history based on original
documents where possible. It
is destroyed by fire.

1649 King Charles I executed.
Charles II crowned.
Oliver Cromwell seizes
power in England.

Alan XIII & Clan join Royalist 1650
forces fighting Cromwell. At
Battle of Inverkeithing, Alan 1651
and most of his clansmen die
fighting rear guard action.

Cromwellian forces invade
Scotland.
Scotland under protect-
orate of Cromwell.

John & Donald MacQuarrie of Ulva cited for a 'decreet' i.e. a judgement against them. Reason not specified.

Duke of Argyll & his Campbell clan embark upon a private war in the field and his own courts for possession of Mull, Ulva & other lands, on pretext of debts owed him. Lachlan VIX witnesses document for formal surrender of Maclean possessions.

John of Laggan, uncle of Lachlan XIV, bars King's messengers from Duart Castle. Both are denounced as rebels.

Hector MacQuarrie, uncle of Lachlan XIV declared a rebel. Argyll sends Lachlan ejection letter, apparently ignored.

Lachlan held liable for some property lifted and for raiding as far as LochLonghead.

John(Laggan) garrisons Cairnburgh Castle, Treshish Isles.

Lachlan XIV confirmed as heir, forced to give 500 merk bond for good behavior to help secure peace in the Highlands.

Lachlan XIV's home and all Clan papers burned.

MacQuarrie of Ormaig brings clan to support Vicount Dundee and James II at victorious Battle of Killiecrankie.

Privy Council confiscates land of Lachlan XIV for bearing arms against government. Duke of Argyll ordered to bring Mull to King Wm's obedience.

Lachlan XIV swears allegiance to King William; confiscation of his estate revoked.

1660 Charles II restored to throne of United Kingdom. James Graham, Marquis of Montrose executed.

1674-1680 Argyll repudiates his own and father's debts while pursuing his creditors in his own courts.

Privy Council gives Argyll a commission of 'Fire & Sword', a sanction to wage war for his own benefit. Argyll is member of Privy Council.

1675

1679

1680

1683

1685 Death of Charles II

1685 Earl of Argyll executed for treason.

1688 James II of Great Britain deposed. Supporters take up arms in Scotland.

1689 Wm. & Mary reign in his place.

1690 Late in swearing allegiance to King Wm, the MacDonalds are massacred at Glencoe by the Argyll Campbells.

James MacQuarrie listed as student at Glasgow University.	1693	
James(another) & Thomas MacQuarrie students at GlasgowU.	1699 1701	James II dies in exile. JamesIII(The Pretender) claims throne in exile.
John MacQuarrie student at Glasgow University.	1707	Union of Parliaments of Scotland and England.
Alan of Culinish, son of Lachlan XIV, cited with some clansmen before admiralty court at Inveraray for theft of oil from whale washed ashore at Kivickewen, Ulva.		
John XV confirmed as heir by John Duke of Argyll.	1731	
John XV dies and is buried on Inchkenneth.	1735	
Alan of Culinish is tutor of young chief Lachlan XVI, son of John XV. Alan registers confirmation from Duke of Argyll of chief's succession.	1739	42nd Highland Regiment, the Black Watch, raised by government to police Highlands. Potato introduced into Highlands.
Disastrous uprising of Highland clans ends the Stuart's attempts to regain throne. MacQuarries listed as rebels were: Name Sentence	1745- 1746	The "Old Pretender's" son, Prince Charles Edward Stuart returns to Scotland to reclaim his father's throne. After a series of spectacular victories, the rebellion is crushed at Culloden Moor.
2395 Donald Transportation		
2396 Donald "		
2397 Alexander "		
2398 Donald "		
2399 John "		
2400 John "		
2401 John "		
2402 John "		
2403 John General Pardon		
2404 John "		
Lachlan, future governor of New South Wales & grandson of Lachlan XIV, is born of the Ormaig branch, the poorest.	1761 1763	French and Indian War in North America.
James Boswell & Samuel Johnson tour the Hebrides and visit Ulva. They find Lachlan XVI 'intelligent, polite and much a man of the world'.	1773 1775	American Revolution begins with battles of Lexington and Concord.

Ulva and other Clan lands sold at public sale in Edinburgh to Dugald Campbell. Lachlan XVI heavily in debt, largely to Duke of Argyll who since the 'Maclean War' has been allowed by Crown to collect rent from MacQuarrie holdings in Argyll.	1777	
Lachlan XVI, aged 62, joins 74th Argyll Highlanders as a Lieutenant. 74th posted to Halifax, Nova Scotia, then to Penobscot(now Castine), Maine, where Lachlan XVI participates in in land/sea battle won by British.	1777	
	1778	
74th returns to Britain & Captain Lachlan XVI mustered out and retires on half-pay for 35 more years.	1783	Treaty of Paris, USA independent. Act proscribing highland dress repealed.
Campbells sell Ulva to Colin MacDonald of South Uist.	1788	Prince Charles Stuart dies, Stuart dynasty ends.
General Lachlan Macquarie, cousin of Lachlan XVI, governor of New South Wales. Called "Father of Australia"	1810-1821	Many MacQuarries listed in military(1800-1841), most served in India. On roll of commissioned officers were 1 Major General, 1 Colonel, 5 Captains and numerous Lieutenants and Ensigns.
Lachlan XVI dies aged 103; last confirmed Chief of Clan MacQuarrie. His children all predeceased him.	1818	
Gen. Lachlan Macquarie dies.	1824	Mass emigrations to Canada USA, Australia and New Zealand after the "Clearances of the Highlands" throughout the 19th century.
William Clark buys Ulva which was scene of thriving kelp industry. After kelp market collapses, Clark replaces people on Ulva with sheep. Ulva did not support sheep industry either.	1835	
	1845	
Population of Ulva reduced from 828 to 150 by	1851	
Lance Corporal Jonathan Carter MacQuarrie is one of troopers in 'Charge of the Light Brigade', Crimean War.		
Macquarie University founded in Sydney, Australia.	1967	

Part 2

THE MacQUARRIE HERITAGE--
THE MacQUARRIES OF SCOTLAND

by

Rodney McQuary

Chapter I Introduction

Historical research has found the beginnings and development of most Scottish Clans to be a very knotty problem. This is especially true of the MacQuarries. One reason is the Clan is very old; one of the 3 or 4 most ancient in Scotland. Its origins are enshrouded in the mists of great antiquity and references to it in history are few, scattered and obscure. Clan MacQuarrie was small in size and power compared to the MacLeans, MacGregors and MacDonalds. Instead of leading ambitious schemes of conquest, the MacQuarrie Chiefs were allies and supporters of others, 1st the MacDonalds, later the MacLeans of Duart.

Another difficulty is that many of the most important records of the Clan were destroyed. Smibert says, "Most of the family papers of the MacQuarries were destroyed by fire in 1688, leaving the annals of the family more dubious than they might otherwise have been." [53].

In records the name is spelled in a variety of ways. The most common are: MacQuarrie, MacGuarie and MacQuaire, derived from ancient Gaelic form MacGuidhre. Some believe that the name was derived from the adjective "quarrie", which means "noble", so they would use a small q, Macquarrie. Others thinking the family ancestor was Guarie, a prince of the Alpine line, prefer the spelling "MacGuairie" or "MacQuarrie". The capital G/Q indicates derivation from the name of a person rather than an adjective.

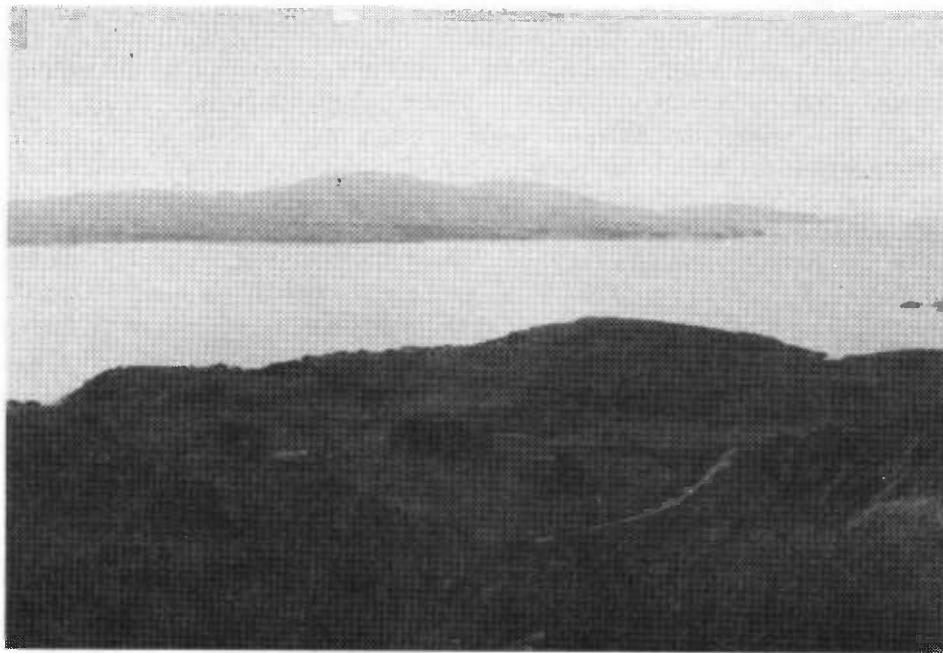
By ancient tradition the MacQuarries were closely related to the MacKinnons, and less closely to the MacDonalds of Sleat [whose tartan is very similar to the MacQuarrie tartan with a double green strip replacing a single one]. Except for the sparseness of genealogical records in the Islands, it is fortunate for the student that for many centuries the MacQuarries were active mainly in the region of the Isle of Ulva. Long before the 18th century this hardy breed of Highlanders held the isles of Ulva, Staffa, Little Colonsay and a part of Mull.

The name "Ulva" means in Norse "wolves." Did this refer to wolves infesting the island at an early date or to the fierce, wolfish character of people who lived there? Anyway MacQuarries were reputed to be a rough, turbulent lot, always ready for a "quaich of whiskey or a foray." They fought equally well with bow and arrow, long two-handed sword or battle-axe. Described as "the most acquisitive raiders who ever purloined barley", they were "bad soldiers, but good plunderers." Bad not as fighters, but in their unwillingness to submit to ordinary military discipline.

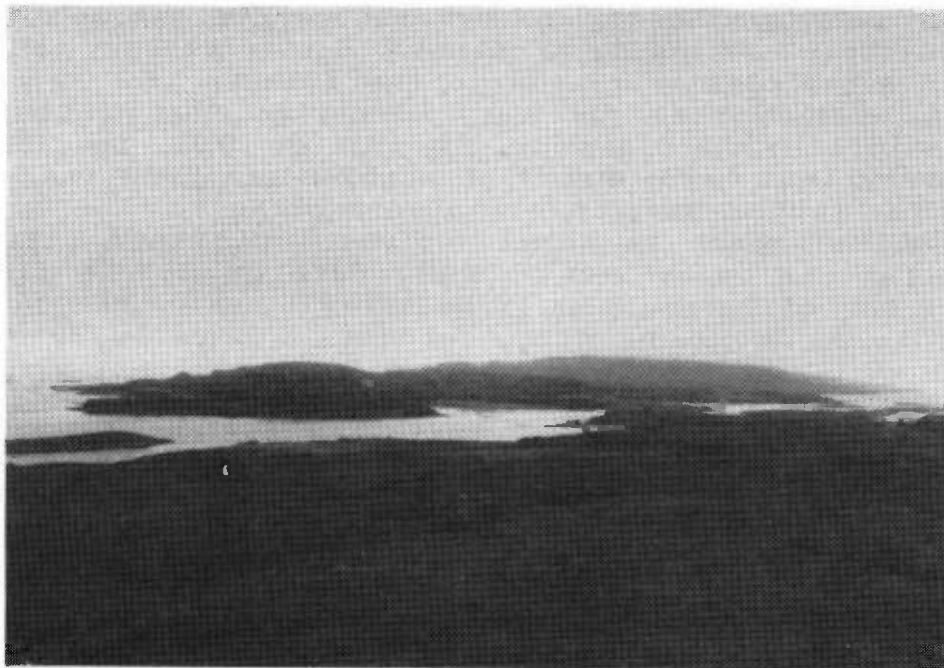
The MacQuarrie emblem was the pine tree, a variety best able to resist a strong gale. The crest depicted a dagger held aloft, ready to strike and the war-cry was a blood-curdling yell in Gaelic: "An t'arm breac deag," which is best translated, "Here come the red-spattered tartans."

In putting down the Jacobite uprisings of 1715 and especially 1745, the English took strong repressive measures against the Clans. Highlanders were forbidden to carry arms, wear kilts or play bagpipes. The prohibition of the kilt lasted until 1782.

The status of Chiefs changed radically in 1747 when hereditary jurisdictions were abolished. This meant they were dispossessed



Kilbrennan Farm. Ulva in the background.



Isle of Ulva

of their legal position as magistrates, adjudicating disputes of their people. Many chiefs got monetary compensation and continued living on ancestral lands, using this money to bring needed improvements in agriculture. In many instances the Chiefs' prestige as heads of Clans was not greatly diminished. This was case with Lachlan MacQuarrie(1715-1818), last hereditary Chief of the MacQuarries of Ulva. The Island was not taken from him until sold at public auction in 1777, to pay off long standing mortgages.

Many of the MacQuarries continued to stay on Ulva as tenants of the new owner; others emigrated to Canada and the United States. Later some settled in New South Wales(NSW) and the Far East. As time passed they scattered over the earth, giving a good account of themselves. A large number of them came to hold positions of prominence and influence in all walks of life.

Two MacQuarries best known to history were the last chief and Major General Lachlan Macquarie(1761-1824), the great Governor of NSW. Confusion arises since they had the same name and they were cousins, not father and son as has been sometimes said.

Chief Lachlan achieved immortality by being mentioned at some length by James Boswell and Dr. Johnson in their Journal of 1773. The Chief was their genial host overnight and the Journal speaks of him very appreciatively.[see Chap. VII].

Major General Macquarie was a controversial figure during his lifetime because of certain policies and measures which he put into effect in NSW. His enemies finally brought about his resignation, but history has almost wholly vindicated him. Today he is considered a really great man whose most serious fault was merely that he was ahead of his time.[see Chap. VIII].

It remains to speak briefly of some of the non-modern sources of information upon which we depended. The ancient Scots, like the Irish and other peoples of the olden time, preserved stories of their past in the form of oral tradition, instead of written history. Each court, Clan and district had its own storyteller, the sennachie, who together with a bard reduced the story ,to musical form. Gregg[23] describes their function: " The sennachie were the only custodians and historians of the tradition and genealogy of families... As their fund of information was handed down from father to son, without use of writing, only the most important events were kept.

"It was the custom for the sennachie to make a yearly round of the homes in his district and to relate the important events that had occurred since his previous visit. These related chiefly to births, deaths, marriages and transfers of property. As time went on, the sennachie began to put these accounts into written form. They met regularly... to compare and exchange records. The material thus gathered was put into permanent form... and forms today the only genuine history of ancient Scotland."

Mitchell[??] says: "To the highland Clans the office of sennachy was one of the highest importance, for upon the accuracy of his work depended... the rights of families. It was these pedigrees that demonstrated the relationship between individuals and the acknowledged father of the Clan, and upon that relationship depended the land each individual was entitled to hold".

For the dates and reigns of the early Scottish kings during

the Celtic period we are dependent on several early chronicles. Many of these were edited and compared by the great scholar W.F. Skene(1809-1892). Skene, a lawyer by profession, gave much time to historical and archeological study. Since he believed the Scotch Highlanders were direct descendants of the Picts, he gave prominence to the Pictish Chronicle, Colbertine.

Another chronicle featured by Skene was, "Chronicle of the Scottish Nation" by John Fordoun(? -1384) a secular priest and chaplain in Aberdeen Cathedral. His was the earliest attempt to write a continuous history of Scotland, "all other efforts having resulted(merely) in brief chronicles of genealogical memoranda".

Andrew of Wyntoun(c1350-1420), Canon of St. Andrews and Prior of St. Serf's(Lochleven), and Fordoun share the distinction as fathers of Scottish history, though each worked independently. Wyntoun's work entitled, "The Orygynale Cronykill of Scotland", was written in metrical form and covered from mythical beginnings down to the accession of James I in 1406. Since it is in the vernacular speech of his day it has value for philology, and the later parts of it are very authoritative historically.

Hector Boece(1465-1536) wrote a 17-book "History of Scotland", "... a glorification of the Scottish nation, based on legendary sources, and is more interesting as romance than as history". Shakespeare's "MacBeth" is traceable to this by way of Holinshed who borrowed from it liberally. Boece claimed to have certain original histories of Scotland from the Abbey at Icolmkill, including Veremundas' whose writings have completely disappeared.

Raphael Holinshed(?-c1580), of England, wrote "The Scottish Chronicle", saying it was an accurate narration ...of the Scottish nation from the original thereof unto the year 1585". An interesting book, it is not considered original nor particularly valuable as history.

The basic and oldest source for knowledge of St. Columba (?-597) is the biography by Abbot Adamnan(624-?). He came from Donegal, Ireland, the same general locality as did St. Columba and was 9th in succession after Columba as Abbot of Iona.

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Turris Fortis Mihi Deus.
God is a strong tower to me.

Clan MacQuarrie Motto

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